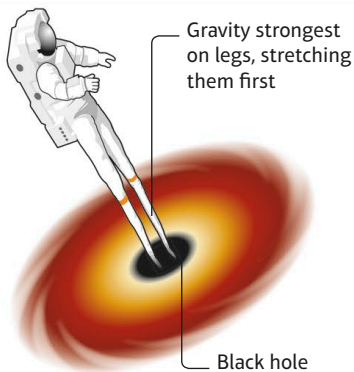


BLACK HOLES

When a red supergiant dies, its core collapses under its own weight, forming a black hole. It is “black” because its intense gravity prevents light escaping, and a “hole” because it traps everything else too. The centres of galaxies often contain supermassive black holes, billions of times heavier than the Sun.

SPAGHETTIFICATION



The gravitational pull of a black hole rises so steeply nearby that an astronaut falling into one would be stretched like spaghetti and torn apart.

A brilliant quasar is **hot** gas around a **supermassive** black hole.